

2024 GATOR ITE ANNUAL REPORT

INSTITUTE OF TRANSPORTATION ENGINEERS
UNIVERSITY OF FLORIDA STUDENT CHAPTER

MESSAGE FROM THE PRESIDENT

As President of Gator ITE at the University of Florida, I am proud to present our annual report, highlighting the remarkable growth of our organization and the extensive educational, leadership, networking, and professional development opportunities we have offered our students.

Our chapter remains deeply committed to expanding outreach to a diverse range of students interested in transportation. Over the past year, these efforts have led to a significant increase in membership and active participation, with a special focus on undergraduate students, planning students, and women in transportation. Notably, two of our board members successfully revived the UF chapter of the Women's Transportation Seminar (WTS), an achievement our ITE chapter has proudly supported through joint events aimed at promoting women's engagement and leadership in transportation.

To further enhance student involvement, we have expanded opportunities to serve on our board by introducing new committees, which foster leadership, active participation, and hands-on learning for all. In line with our commitment to building a strong community, we have also made the commitment to fully in-person general body meetings over dinners, recognizing the significantly enhanced networking opportunities, interpersonal connections, and greater sense of community they offer. We look forward to building on this momentum and continuing to strengthen our community of future transportation professionals.

In addition to our efforts on campus, Gator ITE has provided numerous opportunities for students to participate in prestigious conferences and competitions. This past year, we sent members to the ITE International conference in Philadelphia as well as the Student Leadership Summit at Florida Atlantic University (FAU) in Boca Raton, where they gained valuable exposure to industry professionals, cutting-edge research, and emerging trends in transportation. We are especially proud of our Traffic Bowl team, who competed in the 2024 ITE Collegiate Traffic Bowl Grand Championship in Philadelphia and, more recently, won the FLPR District Championship in Boca Raton.

Looking ahead, Gator ITE remains devoted to fostering a supportive and dynamic environment for transportation students. From cultivating leadership and professional development to promoting diversity and active engagement, our chapter is ready to continue our positive momentum into years to come. We appreciate the dedication of our members, mentors, and partners, and we invite all who are interested to join us on this exciting journey as we pave the way for the next generation of transportation professionals. And lastly, Go Gators!

Garrett Walker
President, Gator ITE

CHAPTER ADMINISTRATION

Gator ITE organized a wide range of meetings throughout the year, including General Body Meetings, Board Meetings, event trips, and outreach/service projects (see Table 1). In February 2024, we proudly hosted the Student Leadership Summit, which brought together over 40 professionals and 70 students for networking, workshops, and leadership development. We also held various social events, including bowling and our annual barbecue at Lake Wauburg. In April, we conducted our annual elections, welcoming new board members and ensuring continued growth for our chapter.

To boost involvement, we used social media, transportation classes, and email lists to promote meetings, workshops, and the opportunities available through ITE. With support from Gator ITE, the Women's Transportation Seminar (WTS) UF chapter was successfully reactivated, allowing us to further expand our outreach among women interested in the transportation field. We also collaborated with other student organizations to broaden our reach and strengthen professional connections.

A list of elected officers is included at the end of the report. As shown below, we hosted 21 general body meetings, in addition to 10 unlisted board meetings.

Date	Description	Location
1/15/2024	Technical Visit to Gainesville Traffic Office	Gainesville, FL
2/9/2024	Gator ITE Student Leadership Summit	Reitz Union
2/20/2024	Vision Zero Open House	Gainesville, FL
3/4/2024	Body Meeting with Kittelson & Associates	University of Florida
3/21/2024	Machine Learning-Enhanced Decision Making Frameworks for Sustainable Mobility Systems ft. Dr. Jimi Oke	Online
3/28/2024	STEAM Night	C.W. Norton Elementary School
4/5/2024	Introductory Board Meeting	Online
4/11/2024	The Promise of AI to Improve Highway Safety ft. Dr. Fred Mannering	University of Florida
4/20/2024	Gator ITE Barbecue at Lake Wauburg	Micanopy, FL
4/25/2024	Civil3D Workshop hosted by Ryan Kenis, E.I.	Online
9/4/2024	Student Organization Fair Tabling	O'Connell Center
9/11/2024	HWCOE New Student Reception Tabling	Reitz Union
9/12/2024	General Body Meeting #1	Weil Hall
9/20/2024	FCITE Gainesville Meeting and Social	Gainesville, FL
9/23/2024	General Body Meeting #2 with Kittelson	Weil Hall
10/16/2024	Bowling Social	Reitz Union
10/23/2024	General Body Meeting #3 with WTS, Alison Moss	Weil Hall
10/23/2024	Lunch with Iteris	I-Street Lab
10/30/2024	GIS Workshop	I-Street Lab
11/9/2024	Adopt-A-Highway Cleanup	University Avenue
11/20/2024	Business in Engineering with Tyler Blair	I-Street Lab

NETWORKING EVENTS

We hosted our events in 2024 with a goal to help members forge professional connections and learn about potential career paths. Representatives from Kittelson & Associates, the City of Gainesville, Gannett-Fleming, Kimley-Horn, and Iteris were invited to our General Body Meetings to share their work and highlight opportunities within their companies. Beyond campus, our chapter participated in GatorSLS 2024, ITE-ITSS Transpo 2024, and the ITE Annual Meeting in Philadelphia. We also took part in the FLPRITE Annual Meeting, FCITE Gainesville Meeting and Social, FAV 2024, and UF's ESSIE Evening with Industry. By combining on-campus presentations with off-campus conferences, Gator ITE provided a broad platform for students to connect with industry leaders and build their network.

Figure 1. Kittelson Roadway Design Meeting



Figure 2. FCITE Gainesville Social



K-12 OUTREACH

C.W. Norton Elementary's annual STEAM Night brought together over 400 attendees, including more than 150 students, for an interactive exploration of various technical fields. Gator ITE participated in both this year's and last year's event, offering students an engaging introduction to the transportation industry. STEAM night allowed Gator ITE to foster curiosity and excitement about transportation among young learners.

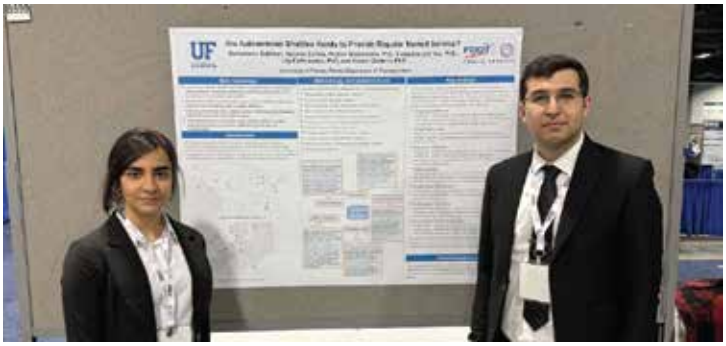
Figure 3. 2024 STEAM Night



APPLYING TECHNICAL KNOWLEDGE

Gator ITE students attended the TRB Annual Meeting and presented more than 14 papers this year. They are listed at http://bit.ly/3QDnpqT. The UFTI team received 2025 Best Paper Award from TRB's Freeway Operations Committee (ACP20).

Figure 4. ITE at TRB



The University of Florida Transportation Institute (UFTI), I-STREET, SERMOS, and Just & Green are labs that support projects involving many Gator ITE students. I-STREET has provided space for research students and opportunities for engagement with industry, government, and other UF departments.

NEW MEMBER RECRUITMENT

Enhancing student engagement was a central goal for Gator ITE this year. To encourage greater undergraduate participation, we actively promoted our events through in-class visits and personal invitations in Transportation Engineering courses. Additionally, our chapter increased its outreach by tabling at both the Student Organization Fair and Engineering New Student Reception, introducing incoming freshmen to our chapter.
As part of our outreach effort, we organized general body meetings to welcome undergraduate students to Gator ITE and showcase the networking, leadership, and learning opportunities our chapter provides.

Figure 5. First Fall 2024 ITE General Body Meeting



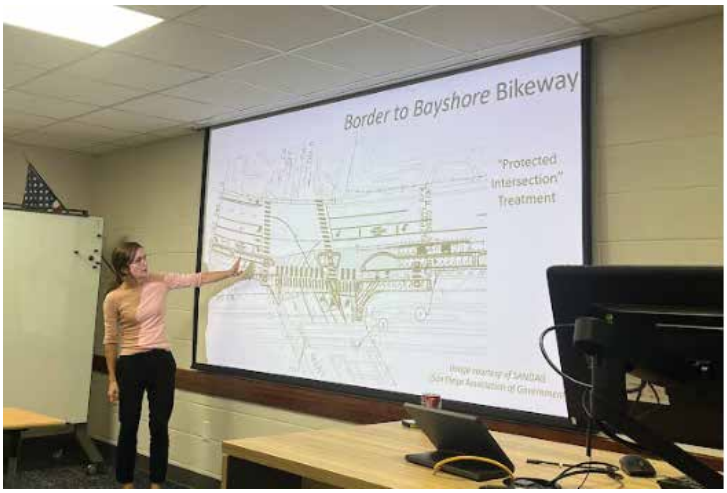
Figure 6. Engineering Student Welcome Tabling



DIVERSITY AND INCLUSION

Our chapter is a diverse and dynamic community, with members representing a wide array of ethnic backgrounds from countries including Brazil, China, India, Iran, Nepal, and the United States. In addition, our membership spans multiple disciplines, such as Sustainability and the Built Environment, Computer Science, Urban and Regional Planning, and Civil and Industrial Engineering. Our board consists of 45% undergraduate and 55% graduate students. This year, we continued our efforts to broaden outreach to women and planning students by co-hosting a joint meeting with the Women's Transportation Seminar (WTS), featuring Alison Moss, AICP. Through these initiatives, we remain committed to fostering an inclusive environment for all future transportation professionals.

Figure 7. Joint ITE-WTS Meeting ft. Alison Moss



PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Professional development remained a top priority for Gator ITE this year, ensuring members gained both industry insights and practical skills. We worked with UFTI faculty to present lectures that covered emerging research on critical transportation issues. Additionally, we hosted workshops on Civil 3D, ArcGIS, roadway design, and business development, offering hands-on experience with widely used tools and practices.

Figure 8. Business in Engineering Workshop



FIELD TRIPS AND TECHNICAL TOURS

Gator ITE took part in the Vision Zero Open House, a Gainesville community forum focused on road safety initiatives. This event provided an opportunity to engage in meaningful discussions with local stakeholders, including residents, FDOT, Alachua County, and Shands Hospital. By participating, we gained valuable insights and feedback that broadened our perspective on ongoing transportation safety projects. We also visited the Gainesville City Traffic Operations Office for a technical tour.

Figure 9. Vision Zero Open House





SERVICE PROJECTS

During this year, Gator ITE members participated in a highway cleanup as part of the "Adopt-A-Highway" program, contributing to a cleaner Gainesville. Our chapter has held this event annually along University Avenue.

Figure 10. 2024 Gator ITE Adopt-A-Highway Cleanup



CHAPTER AWARDS

We are proud to highlight our chapter's achievements in student competitions over the past year, including:

- FLPRITE District Outstanding Student Chapter Award
- 2025 FLPR District Traffic Bowl Champion
- FLPRITE District Student Volunteer of the Year Award (Gustavo Zschaber)
- President's Challenge Coin (Gustavo Zschaber)
- William R. McGrath FLPRITE District Award (Renan Favero)
- William R. McGrath FLPRITE District Award, Second Place (Gustavo Zschaber)
- Anne S. Brewer Scholarship (Renan Favero)
- COMTO's National Scholarship Program (Renan Favero)
- Shark Tank Competition, Second Place (Gustavo Zschaber)
- Anne S. Brewer Scholarship (Bryce Grame)
- TRB Best Paper Award, Abiral Aashish

Figure 11. ITE Student Awards at Transpo 2024



LEADERSHIP DEVELOPMENT

The Student Leadership Summit (SLS) provided valuable networking and hands-on leadership opportunities, with professionals sharing industry challenges and career strategies. We also hosted an interactive workshop on communication and decision-making at SLS, along with a November business engineering workshop led by Tyler Blair, P.E., which focused on business development and leadership roles.

Additionally, we expanded our board by introducing four new committee positions, allowing new members to step into leadership roles and actively contribute to chapter initiatives.

Figure 12. Gator ITE Barbecue Social



ELECTED OFFICERS

Garrett Walker, President; Mohammadreza Mirzaei, Vice President; Renan Favero, Treasurer; Kayla Eusebio, Outreach Coordinator; Ayame Soejima, Social Media Coordinator & Event Coordinator; Mohaddese Salehian, Secretary; Zachary Anderson, Event Coordinator; Bryce Grame, Traffic Bowl Coordinator; Michael Hayes, External Outreach Coordinator; Kyle Groome, Social Media Coordinator; Sanidhya Dadia, Internal Outreach Coordinator.